

UNLIMITED CLAIMS BENEFIT

With double-digit medical inflation and advanced treatments costing a lot, the unlimited claim benefit has emerged as a powerful safeguard for policyholders.

This optional rider acts as a financial shield during critical illnesses or major medical emergencies requiring prolonged hospitalisation or expensive procedures. For example, Manipal Cigna's Sarvah Uttam with the Anant Rider offers no limit on claims for conditions like cancer, heart disease, stroke, or organ/bone marrow transplants every year.

This is how it works: Even if your base sum insured is ₹30 lakh, and you face a treatment bill of ₹1 crore or more, this rider ensures the entire amount is covered—with no upper limit. Some insurers allow this benefit once in a lifetime, while others offer it annually.

MAKE THE MOST OF WHAT YOU DON'T USE

Another customer-centric feature is the ability to carry forward unused sum insured, tackling a common consumer frustration—why pay for something you don't use?

"Many young people feel they're paying for insurance they may never claim. Niva Bupa Aspire policy addresses that by rolling over any unutilised sum insured to the next policy year," explains Bhabatosh Mishra, Director of Product, Claims, and Underwriting at Niva Bupa.

For example, you have a ₹10 lakh policy and use only ₹5 lakh in one year, the remaining ₹5 lakh is added to the next year's sum insured. Over 10 years, this can accumulate up to ₹1 crore, creating a safety net as you age. The good part is that when you make a claim,



"Customers are no longer limited to predefined plans. With new-age products, they can build a policy that mirrors their health needs and lifestyle"

ANAND ROY

MD & CEO, STAR HEALTH & ALLIED INSURANCE

it does not reset to the base, but only that amount is reduced which is used.

LOCK YOUR PREMIUM

Traditionally, health insurance premiums increase as policyholders age. But with the new Age Freeze feature, insurers are now rewarding early buyers with long-term savings.

This option allows customers to lock in their premium at the age they buy the policy—and continue paying the same rate until they either make a claim or reach a defined age cap.

Galaxy Health Insurance's Premium Promise allows customers to pay the same premium until they make a claim or turn 55—whichever comes first.

So, if a 30-year-old purchases a policy and remains claim-free, they can pay the same premium for up to 25 years, despite growing older. That said, premiums may still rise to account for medical inflation.

This feature not only ensures huge savings over time but also nudges younger individuals to invest in health insurance early, when premiums are at their lowest and health risks minimal.

NO MORE HIDDEN COSTS

Hospitalisation bills are not just limited to room rent or doctor consultations. A substantial chunk often comes from non-medical or consumable items such as gloves, syringes, and PPE kits.

While these items are essential for treatment, they were traditionally excluded from insurance coverage, leaving patients with significant out-of-pocket expenses—even if they had a robust health policy.

Recognising this gap, several insurers have introduced policies that explicitly cover consumables and non-payable items.

For instance, Galaxy Health Insurance offers coverage for 68 different consumables, including admission and insurance processing charges.

"We cover 68 consumables, plus admission, record, and insurance processing charges," says G. Srinivasan, MD & CEO of Galaxy Health Insurance.

The inclusion of such expenses is a game-changer, especially in times like the Covid-19 pandemic, when PPE kits and disposable items